ALIA PHAN

Phanthaolinh05@gmail.com | 309-948-9161 | www.linkedin.com/in/alia-phan | Rock Island, IL

EDUCATION

Augustana College Rock Island, IL
Bachelor of Arts in Accounting, Business Intelligence, and Business Finance May 2027 (CPA Eligible)
GPA: 3.7 - Dean's List, Academic Merit Scholarship, J. Ingemanson Scholarship, and Friends of Accounting
Relevant Coursework: Intermediate Accounting, Auditing, Tax Accounting, Advanced Tax, Business Statistics, Financial Management.

EXPERIENCE

The Research Foundation for The State University of New York Sep 2024 – Sep 2026
Financial Accounting Intern Albany, New York

- Strengthen internal controls by processing and reconciling 700+ monthly invoices, purchase orders, and supplier records in Oracle ERP, achieving 98% accuracy and reducing AP rework by 5 hours monthly.
- Achieve a 15% boost in payment accuracy through daily audits and inbox management, minimizing vendor disputes and strengthening supplier relationships.
- Reduce document retrieval time by 30% by standardizing financial records across AP, Purchasing, and Sponsored Programs — accelerating month-end close and supporting audit readiness.
- Boost team efficiency by leading weekly cross-functional process improvement meetings and creating shared templates, enabling faster onboarding and consistent knowledge sharing.

Augustana College May 2025 – Aug 2025
Summer Conference Assistant Rock Island, IL

- Increased attendee satisfaction by supporting 1,000+ guests via email, phone, and in-person, strengthening the college's hospitality reputation.
- Improved efficiency by 20% by managing check-in/check-out and logistics for 14 conferences, reducing wait times, and optimizing staff resources.
- Ensured smooth operations by resolving 50+ facility issues and last-minute inquiries, preventing disruptions and keeping events on schedule.

PROJECTS

Forensic Interview & Fraud Investigation Case Study

- Analyzed a $10,000 cash theft at a microbrewery by evaluating cash receipts, point-of-sale transactions, bank deposits, and supporting documentation to identify control deficiencies and potential sources of misappropriation.
- Used Microsoft Excel (PivotTables, XLOOKUP, conditional formatting, and data reconciliation) to compare transaction records, identify discrepancies, quantify losses, and summarize findings.
- Assessed the effectiveness of internal controls, recommended improvements to strengthen cash handling procedures, and presented audit conclusions in a formal report.

Tax Return Preparation Project

- Prepared a comprehensive Form 1040 for a fictional married couple filing jointly with two qualifying dependents by reporting W-2 wages, Schedule C self-employment income, Schedule E rental real estate income, and Schedule D capital gains. Calculated adjusted gross income, itemized deductions (Schedule A), child-related tax credits, and overall federal tax liability.
- Completed a Form 1120 for a fictional C corporation by analyzing trial balance and financial statement data, identifying permanent and temporary book-to-tax differences, calculating taxable income, depreciation, charitable contribution limitations, net operating loss considerations, deductible business expenses, and the corporation's federal income tax liability.

LEADERSHIP & INVOLVEMENT

CFA Institute Research Challenge – 2nd Place, Iowa Sub-Regional Oct 2025 – Feb 2026
Hosted by CFA Society Iowa

- Placed 2nd out of 9 universities; delivered a BUY recommendation on O'Reilly Automotive (NASDAQ: ORLY) with a $117 target price representing 24.5% upside.
- Led industry and competitive positioning analysis; built relative valuation models (P/E, EV/EBITDA, P/S) across peers to evaluate profitability and margin sustainability.
- Collaborated with a three-member team to present to CFA charterholders and portfolio managers; recognized for analytical depth, cohesive narrative, and technical clarity.

Student Investment Fund Member Sep 2023 – Present
Sector Analyst in Utilities Industry Rock Island, IL

- Conducted DCF models and comparable company analysis on 3+ utilities sector equities, delivering buy/hold/sell recommendations to a student-managed fund with $~$282K AUM.
- Improved team efficiency by 10% by implementing a cloud-based document system, streamlining file sharing and reducing version control errors.

Innovation Competition Team Aug 2025 – Present
Finance Research Analyst Rock Island, IL

- Developed data-backed product launch strategy using Nielsen market data and competitor analysis, earning judge recognition.
- Delivered high-quality financial analyses under strict deadlines, strengthening team credibility and enabling polished recommendations to judges.

Expedition EY Program Mar 2026 – Present
Ernst & Young Virtual

- Selected (top 10%) for EY's Expedition program; gained exposure to audit and assurance workflows, advisory services, and client communication.

SKILLS

Software & Systems: Oracle Business Applications, Visio, Tableau, Power BI, Excel (Advanced), Adobe Acrobat, Canva
Accounting & Analysis: Financial Modeling, Account Reconciliation, Internal Controls, Valuation, GAAP, Financial Analysis, Data Visualization